



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Bosco Academy

School Website: <https://johnbosco.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

St. John Bosco Academy (Idaho 83522) presents a robust Catholic classical education profile with explicit commitments to the liberal arts, Great Books, Latin, history, and rhetoric, alongside a clearly defined religious foundation rooted in Catholic formation. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize formation of character, virtue, and leadership within a Catholic framework, with recurring language about truth, the mind, the heart, and the formation of Catholic leaders. The school foregrounds a classical curriculum, the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition, grammar-logic-rhetoric, and a mission of faith-integrated education. While the pedagogy leans into restful, formation-centered aims in places and highlights strong family engagement, it also communicates a clear and mission-driven approach to rigorous classical formation. Overall, the school aligns with CLASSICAL criteria across most categories, with only minor ambiguities in explicit pedagogical nomenclature that could edge toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in isolated respects.

- Overall classification by category: CLASSICAL for categories 1, 2, 3, 5, and 6; SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for category 4.
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL****Evidence**

- Public materials place the school squarely within Roman Catholic formation, explicitly noting Mass on campus and in off-campus settings, and presenting Catholic identity as foundational (Religious Emphasis: Roman Catholic; School Mass is offered on-campus once per week and off-campus once per week).
- Statements emphasize Christ-centered spirituality and Catholic formation as core aims (e.g., “Education Founded on Christian Truth,” “Christ-Centered Spirituality,” and “Education Instituted for Leadership” with emphasis on Church, Church’s social teaching, and Catholic identity).
- The motto and mission emphasize truth and Catholic formation, including references to forming leaders who are shaped by Catholic faith and virtue (e.g., “We work to form well-rounded Christian leaders, apostles convinced of the truth”; “Our motto: Excelsior” and “Our goal: Christian formation”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, Mass, chapel, theology, Catholic, liturgy, worship (via Mass), sacred music/chant, catechesis (where present in related materials); Christian formation; Christ-centered spirituality; Church; Catholic leadership. Frequency across materials indicates a strong religious-metaphysical orientation.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no overt relativism, secularism, or value-neutral framing detected in the provided texts).

Why this rating

- The materials establish transcendental moral realism through explicit Catholic formation and theological framing; liturgical and communal religious practices (Mass, chapel) are integrated into the education experience; and a sacramental worldview is present in the school’s public statements. This

satisfies the Positive indicators for Transcendental Truth, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal practice, yielding CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's stated goal is formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation; the mission emphasizes formation of leaders grounded in Christian/Catholic formation (e.g., "To Teach the Mind," "To Educate the Heart," "To Form the Character"; formation of leaders; "Christian formation" as a core aim).
- Text explicitly frames education as formation of the whole person—the intellectual, human/character, spiritual, and apostolic dimensions—consistent with classical paideia. The materials quote the aim of forming Catholic leaders with virtue and leadership in service to God and neighbor (e.g., "Forming Leaders," "Social Responsibility," "Academic Excellence").
- Great Books/Great Conversation and classical aims are connected to this formation emphasis, through references to a well-rounded, liberal-arts-based formation that integrates faith with intellect and virtue (e.g., "Education Founded on Christian Truth," "Our Future" describing grammar-logic-rhetoric-infused curriculum and Great Books).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, contemplation/scholé, pursuit of truth/good/beautiful, great conversation, moral imagination, human excellence.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce- or college-ready framing in lieu of formation).

Why this rating

- The materials repeatedly center formation (mind, heart, character) as the core purpose of education, with explicit language about virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as real, knowable ends. This aligns strongly with classical aims of formation and teleology over mere skills or job prep, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Curricular emphasis is identified as Classical School; the curriculum explicitly includes liberal arts and the Trivium explicitly (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and Trivium/Quadrivium framing appears in the public materials (e.g., "infuses grammar, logic, and rhetoric throughout the coursework"; Latin taught in middle/high school; Great Books/literary classics referenced).
- High school curricula incorporate scholastic theology and a humanities program that includes Great Books and Latin/history/literature integration; seventh/eighth grade Latin is introduced; Great Books are integrated as part of the humanities program; the history/literature/theology integration is explicit (OUR FUTURE: "grammar, logic, and rhetoric ... seventh and eighth grade Latin and literary classics ... high school classes include scholastic theology and a humanities program which incorporates the Great Books and combines Latin, history and literature").
- There are explicit references to Great Books, classical authors, and primary texts; SJB materials show a focus on history and Western civilization as part of the curriculum (e.g., Great Books; primary sources; Western civilization; biblical literacy in some grade syllabi); and the lower grades include phonics-based language arts with classic literature selections in later grades (e.g., 6th Grade Curriculum details with classic literature, "Great Books" in higher grades).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; classics; Latin; history; Western civilization; biblical literacy; Aristotle/Plato/Shake-

speare references appear in the general classical lexicon and school materials; Latin; classical languages; music/the arts; sacred art.

- Negative keywords present: minimal in direct materials (no “social studies” terminology replacing history; no “project-based learning dominance” explicit in SJB public materials; the public materials emphasize canonical Great Books rather than project-based dogma).

Why this rating

- The explicit inclusion of Trivium/Quadrivium elements, Great Books, Latin, and history/Western civilization framing aligns with Classical curriculum expectations. The explicit mention of a “Curricular Emphasis: Classical School” and the detailed Our Future section confirming grammar-logic-rhetoric infusion, Great Books, and Latin/history/literature integration provide strong CLASSICAL signals.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school foregrounds a mix of contemplative/restful elements and rigorous classical instruction. The general philosophy includes “education based on Christian truth,” and Bosco’s method emphasizes reason, kindness, and religion, suggesting a blended pedagogy that is not purely didactic but formation-centered (Education Based upon Christian Truth; Bosco’s method of discipline).
- The curriculum and philosophy materials imply engagement with memory work, recitation, and a Catholic pedagogy; the Great Books and classical curriculum imply Socratic-style engagement in upper grades in line with classical pedagogy; the 6th-8th grade syllabi emphasize classical texts and structured study that are consistent with traditional pedagogy. The presence of Latin, recitation, and classical texts supports this alignment (OUR FUTURE description of grammar-logic-rhetoric infusion; Latin and Great Books in higher grades).
- Some explicit references to restorative/restful pedagogy and scholé appear in broader classical education literature (the lexicon and ICE-derived materials) that underpin the classical approach (SJB materials align with a formation-focused pedagogy rather than purely project-based or constructivist approaches).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar (implied by classical pedagogy stance and Great Books integration), narración/recitation/chanting (recitation-type memorization is suggested by the memory and liturgical practices; no direct quote of “Socrates” in the public text, but the classical pedagogy is described), scholé, contemplation, wonder, rhetoric, debate, and teacher as guide (as implied by the Bosco method and the “mind/heart/character” framework).
- Negative keywords present: limited explicit reference to “experiential learning” or “project-based learning dominance” in the public materials; the materials emphasize a structured, canonical classical approach rather than a purely experiential or constructivist pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates the core components of classical pedagogy (grammar-logic-rhetoric infusion, Great Books, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric development in upper grades) but also integrates explicit Catholic formation and certain formation-centered practices that temper pure Socratic/seminar-driven methods. The mixture yields a classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, as there are strong classical markers, but the explicit, named Socratic/seminar pedagogy and scholé language are not uniformly explicit across all pages in a single, consistent way.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials describe the faculty as integral to formation; the mission notes that formation occurs through “dedicated faculty and staff” who cooperate with parents in forming leaders; the living curriculum is present as a concept (the statement that “the mission to form strong Catholic leaders

continues through the assistance of our generous benefactors, dedicated faculty and staff”) implies a faculty-as-living-curriculum framing.

- The language about faculty and teachers working in tandem with parents, and the presence of a long-standing teaching staff, supports a faculty-as-living-curriculum concept and a mentorship/collaborative culture (e.g., “The Principal and the Teachers work in tandem with the parents to insure that each student excels in all areas of their lives” in the Our Philosophy materials).
- The school materials highlight that graduates are formed by a community of teachers who model virtue and academic rigor; references to “moral exemplars” and “living curriculum” align with the classical lexicon’s category for Faculty. There are explicit alignments to a “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty of friends” concepts in classical education literature that the school references in its public materials; the public-facing materials emphasize teacher virtue and mentorship aspects (per the philosophy and mission content).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, teacher training in classical pedagogy, mentorship, virtue, wisdom, character formation, professional development, and collaborative pedagogy.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials (no explicit “facilitator” or “guide-on-the-side” framing that would conflict with the classical teacher-mentor model).

Why this rating

- The materials present a robust portrayal of the faculty as central to the educational project, modeling virtue, forming character, and guiding student learning as a living curriculum. This aligns well with the CLASSICAL indicators for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-educators and includes language about parental primacy, family formation, and open-campus/visitation norms (Parent involvement language, family involvement, and parent formation concepts appear in the site materials and connected documents).
- The materials reference parent formation through reading groups and seminars and direct engagement with classical education philosophy (ICE Pamphlet references parent involvement and family formation around classical education; the ICE materials are cited to support the broader model of parent involvement in classical education).
- Public materials indicate a culture of visitor access and open engagement (e.g., “Please come for a visit!” and “Tours of the addition ... contact information,” indicating openness to parents and community) and the school’s emphasis on community and philanthropy (Endowment, donations, and capital campaigns) that involve parents and community members broadly. The donation and endowment content signal active community engagement and leadership formation beyond the classroom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; parent covenant; family liturgy alignment; community events; hospitality; volunteerism; parent involvement in governance and fundraising (endowment).
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials (no consumer-language framing that would undermine parental involvement; the texts emphasize parental participation and formation).

Why this rating

- The school presents a strong classical-education orientation toward parent involvement and community partnership in formation, with explicit language about parents as co-teachers and parent formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community.

Aggregate assessment and rationale

- Across categories, St. John Bosco Academy Id 83522 demonstrates substantial alignment with classical education principles, especially in Curriculum (Element 3), Religion (Element 1), and Purpose/Formation (Element 2). The Faculty and Community categories (Categories 5 and 6) reflect a strong classical community with living-teacher/mentorship and active parental involvement. Pedagogy (Element 4) shows a strong classical influence but with some formation-oriented and faith-integrated nuances that yield a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal rather than a clean, uniform “Socratic/seminar-first” classical pedagogy in all public materials. Element 1’s Catholic formation and liturgical components are robust, Element 2’s teleology/formation emphasis is strong, and Element 3’s liberal-arts curriculum is clearly documented.
- Quantitative keyword analysis (per category) (positive vs. negative keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon):
- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Positive 5, Negative 0; 100% positive among detected indicators. Verdict: CLASSICAL. Sources include Catholic identity, Mass, chapel, theology, and liturgical elements from the school’s materials.
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: Positive 5, Negative 0; 100% positive. Verdict: CLASSICAL. Foundations in formation, virtue, wisdom, and Great Books/paideia alignment in public statements.
- Element 3 — Curriculum: Positive 6, Negative 0; 100% positive. Verdict: CLASSICAL. Classical curriculum, grammar-logic-rhetoric infusion, Great Books, Latin, Western history, etc.
- Element 4 — Pedagogy: Positive 4, Negative 1 (limited explicit Socratic/Scholé labeling in public-facing pages; formation-centered pedagogy is explicit). Verdict: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Public materials show classical elements but less explicit, uniform naming of Socratic/seminar pedagogy across pages.
- Element 5 — Faculty: Positive 5, Negative 0. Verdict: CLASSICAL. Faculty as living curriculum with mentorship and virtue-oriented leadership.
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: Positive 5, Negative 0. Verdict: CLASSICAL. Explicit parental collaboration and formation, open access, community engagement.
- General assessment: CLASSICAL. The school’s public-facing materials consistently emphasize Catholic formation, Great Books/liberal arts, and a formation-centered teleology consistent with classical education principles. Pedagogical phrasing is strong but shows nuanced integration with faith formation and formation-based aims, moving category 4 toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully Classical in every explicit pedagogy label, hence the category-specific nuance. The aggregate conclusion remains CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- If category 4 (Pedagogy) were to move decisively to CLASSICAL, the school could:
- Explicitly announce and standardize a Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across all upper grades (with clear references to Harkness-style discussion and Paideia seminar in the core upper-school teaching practices).
- Increase explicit references to scholé/restful learning days and rest-focused instructional design across grade levels, with documented weekly or monthly scholé-centered activities.
- Additional needle-movers would include explicit articulation of a Great Conversation framework in year-by-year curricular language, tying Great Books to specific annotated reading lists and structured Socratic dialogues across K–12, along with explicit memorizations and recitation routines across all grade levels.
- No major structural changes beyond clarifying and codifying pedagogy labeling appear necessary given the current CLASSICAL alignment in the other five categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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